WEEK 09 / COMMUNITIES, CREATIVITY, AND PLAYER CULTURE

Indie Games

The rise of indie games and the shift toward player-driven development.

This week we discuss the rise of indie games and the shift toward player-driven development, exploring how independent developers are shaping the gaming landscape and the unique experiences they offer.

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29 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

TOPIC 01

Independent Games and Development

REQUIRED

The Creativity of Indie Video Games

YOUTUBE | ~8 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M-2zIemV2yc&ab_channel=PBSoffbook

The Creativity of Indie Video Games from PBS Off Book

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Independent games for your soul

TED TALK | ~21 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bc5J9So7f9s&ab_channel=TEDxTalks

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Making a Name in Games

ARTICLE | ~35 MIN

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_proquest_journals_1319284231

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

The History of Indie Games

YOUTUBE | ~18 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xtZ2sJt4S9Y&ab_channel=SaveData

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

The Importance of Indie Games

YOUTUBE | ~20 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iTwMqlDC35A&ab_channel=iFrames

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

How Indie Games BEAT The AAA Industry

YOUTUBE | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-EGICLW1LqQ&ab_channel=GoingIndie

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

How One Person Changed Indie Games Forever

YOUTUBE | ~22 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d0Lqt-BHbJ0&ab_channel=ThatGuyGlen

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

How Much Our First Indie Game Made | No Marketing

YOUTUBE | ~12 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L9d--sCmGS4

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Everything I Learned Releasing my First Game on Steam and Consoles

YOUTUBE | ~18 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g-geVoA8Xr4&ab_channel=KyleBanks

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Peak Selling 1 Million Copies Proves That Video Games Just Need To Be Genuine

ARTICLE | ~6 MIN

https://www.thegamer.com/peak-sells-one-million-copies-indie-game-video-games-need-to-be-genuine/

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

The Best 10 Indie Games of 2025 (So Far)

YOUTUBE | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cmIiiLtgwv8&ab_channel=GetIndieGaming

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Everything You Need To Start Making Games (As A Beginner)

YOUTUBE | ~17 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_eK26atXTds&ab_channel=JuniperDev

LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Indie Games: The Movie

DOCUMENTARY

https://library.umaine.edu/auth/EZproxy/test/authej.asp?url=https://video.alexanderstreet.com/p/99BokP6XD

Indie Games: The Movie (Documentary)

EXPLORE FURTHER

Surviving Indie

DOCUMENTARY

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z7CWZhhBMSo&ab_channel=GamestarArts

Surviving Indie (Documentary)

EXPLORE FURTHER

In Venba, gamers play as an Indian immigrant trying to restore lost recipes

ARTICLE

https://www.kcrw.com/culture/shows/good-food/food-video-games-vegan-history-america-passion-fruit/venba-video-game-immigration-assimilation-pj-shahamat

EXPLORE FURTHER

In just one hour, Black Myth Wukong has smashed every other Steam game

ARTICLE

https://www.pcgamesn.com/black-myth-wukong/steam-launch

EXPLORE FURTHER

The creator of Papers, Please wants developers to make weirder, more personal games

ARTICLE

https://www.theverge.com/games/651376/lucas-pope-papers-please-gdc-2025-pioneer-award

EXPLORE FURTHER

In its latest update, Enshrouded's terrifying monsters have players asking 'are we the baddies?'

ARTICLE

https://www.pcgamer.com/games/survival-crafting/in-its-latest-update-enshroudeds-terrifying-monsters-have-players-asking-are-we-the-baddies/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Stardew Valley creator plays down reports he could help resurrect cancelled Minecraft-like Hytale

ARTICLE | HTTPS://WWW.EUROGAMER.NET/STARDEW-VALLEY-CREATOR-PLAYS-DOWN-REPORTS-HE-COULD-HELP-RESURRECT-RECENTLY-CANCELLED-MINECRAFT-LIKE-HYTALE

https://www.eurogamer.net/stardew-valley-creator-plays-down-reports-he-could-help-resurrect-recently-cancelled-minecraft-like-hytale

EXPLORE FURTHER

‘Into the Dead: Our Darkest Days’ Blends ‘This War of Mine’ and ‘State of Decay’ Into an Engaging New Formula

ARTICLE

https://www.vice.com/en/article/into-the-dead-our-darkest-days-blends-this-war-of-mine-and-state-of-decay-into-an-engaging-new-formula-early-access-impressions/

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Almost Gone review - dreamlike puzzles unlock a world of dark unease

ARTICLE

https://www.theguardian.com/games/2020/jun/25/the-almost-gone-review

EXPLORE FURTHER

Little Nightmares, Limbo, and Others Are Drearios

ARTICLE

https://www.houstonpress.com/arts/defining-a-drearios-video-game-20233800

EXPLORE FURTHER

The food is… ME? - Dead Plate Full Horror Game

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MdB9Tdt99Io

EXPLORE FURTHER

Schedule 1 Proves How Important TikTok And Streamers Are For A Game's Success

ARTICLE

https://www.thegamer.com/schedule-1-tiktok-streamer/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Jeff Vogel: Making Games Alone For 30 Years, Unity vs Custom Engine, Indie Survival | Full Time Game Dev Podcast Ep. #046

PODCAST EPISODE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9zYiHllEcU&ab_channel=ThomasBrush

EXPLORE FURTHER

Itch.io

WEBSITE

https://itch.io/

Play/explore indie games, such as those available on Itch.io (many are either completely free or offer a portion of the game as a free preview)

EXPLORE FURTHER

Why ‘Untitled Goose Game’ Is the Chaos We Need Right Now

ARTICLE

https://collider.com/untitled-goose-game-switch-review/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Buckshot Roulette Developer on Making the Game Solo, Feedback & Success

ARTICLE

https://80.lv/articles/buckshot-roulette-developer-on-making-the-game-solo-feedback-success/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Those we didn’t know are ‘Among Us’

ARTICLE

https://theaggie.org/2020/11/20/those-we-didnt-know-are-among-us/